

VALEN LI

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EDUCATION

Julia R. Masterman High School

GPA: W- 4.53/4.0

Robotics Team (Co-Founder & Lead Programmer) | Chess Team (Co-Captain) | AI Club (President)

Philadelphia, PA

Sep 2018 – June 2026

The Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania

Leadership in the Business World (Summer 2025) | UW GPA: 4.0/4.0

Pre-baccalaureate Program- STAT 0001: Intro to Statistics and Data Science

Residential & Remote

Jul 2024 – Aug 2025

EXPERIENCE

Comcast

Software Engineering Intern

Philadelphia, PA

Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

- Developed a GitHub Actions workflow to automate MuleSoft project generation, reducing manual errors and saving developer time
- Orchestrated a CI/CD pipeline integrating GitHub Actions with Concourse for automated deployment
- Engineered a Flask frontend as a user interface, allowing users to configure the pipeline with a single click

Wharton's Stevens Center for Innovation in Finance

Full-Stack App Developer

Philadelphia, PA

Jun 2024 – June 2025

- Enhanced features of a student loan application using PostgreSQL and Spring Boot for API development
- Designed responsive websites for the Finiverse.org project and created web features for data visualization platforms

Research Experience

Machine Learning & Cybersecurity Researcher

Remote

Feb 2025 – Sep 2025

- Carnegie Mellon University:** Developed Self-Adapting Machine Learning Models (SEAL) for phishing detection that outperformed traditional classification models; worked with Prof. Hanan Hibshi and authored research paper
- University of Washington:** Trained ML models (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Random Forest, GNNs) on SMBJ for genetic sequencing, achieving 99.9%+ accuracy on COVID variants

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

FIRST Robotics

Lead Programmer | Mentor | FRC Co-Founder

Philadelphia, PA

Sep 2022 – Present

- Lead Programmer of teams 22284 and 22279 (state-qualifier) simultaneously
- Co-founded FRC team 10918 Bluesteel Dragons and raised \$20k in funding
- Created autonomous programs utilizing Virtual Field Mapping, Computer Vision, and Pure Pursuit algorithms
- Winner of: RoboJawn 2024 | Motivate Award | Think Award

USChess

Chess Team Co-Captain | Tournament Director | Instructor | Coach

Onsite

Sep 2018 – Present

- Co-Captain for Masterman Chess team; held weekly coaching sessions for Elementary and Middle School
- Certified tournament director; volunteered to direct the Philadelphia Elementary/Middle School Chess League
- Earned: >\$3,500 | 2x @ World Open (4th) | 3x @ Nationals (5th) | Liberty Bell (1st) | National Congress (4th)

AWARDS

Good Citizen Award

Awarded by The Union League of Philadelphia (2/5,000 nominated) for hard work, honesty, curiosity, and loyalty

Mar 2025

1st Place - Innovation League 2024

Awarded \$5000 | Prototyped, developed, and pitched an innovative tech startup to a panel of judges

Dec 2024

2nd Place - Ctrl+Shift 2024

Awarded \$2500 | Developed an innovative website that redefines AI education

May 2024

3rd Place - Penn Mathematics Contest

Awarded by The University of Pennsylvania for scoring 65/80 at the Penn Math Contest (PMC IV)

April 2025

Invited to the American Invitational Mathematics Examination

Earned Distinction (Top 5%) on the American Mathematics Competition (12B)

Nov 2024